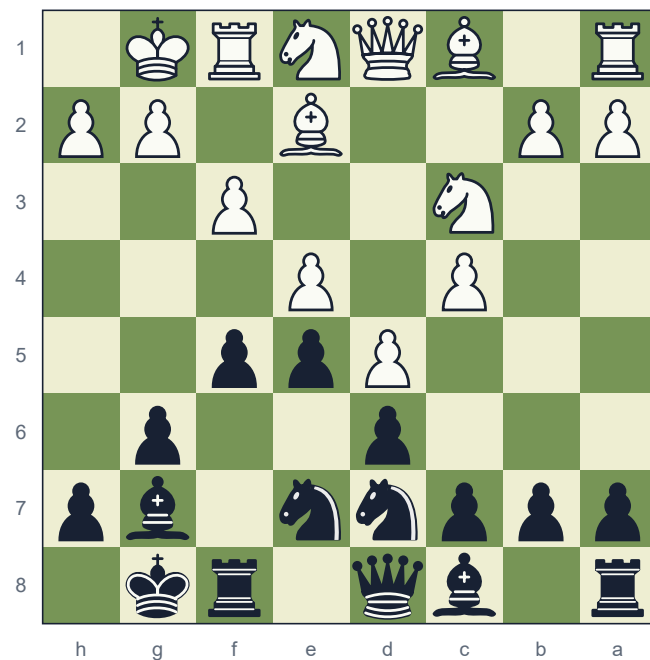


Classical gateway - meet White before the center closes

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...e5, then ...Nc6 against 7.O-O. You invite d5, but White can exchange or keep the central tension. Identify that choice before beginning a pawn attack.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

The defining choice is whether d4 meets e5 by advancing, exchanging, or remaining in contact. Only the advance creates the familiar locked chain.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White develops behind a space advantage. Re1, Be3 and exchanges on e5 can stop Black from getting a routine kingside race.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Check whether the center is actually closed.
2. Do not capture e4 just because it is attacked.
3. After 8.d5 Ne7, identify White's ninth move.

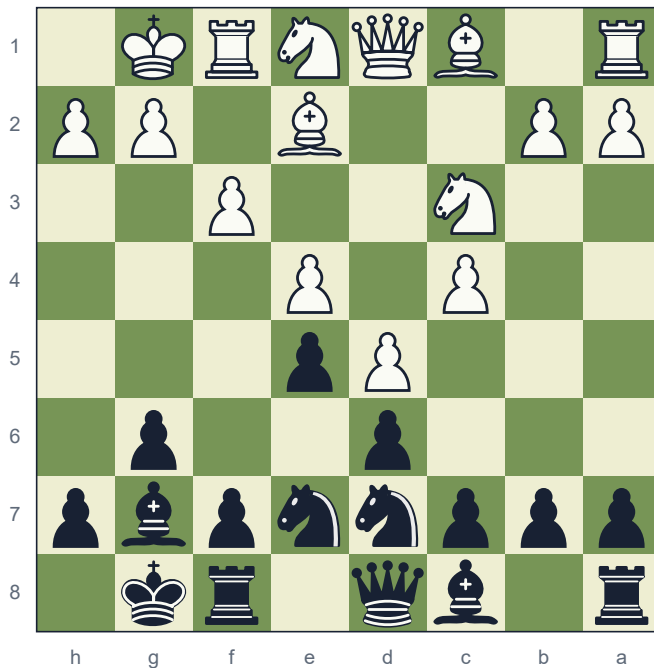
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Main entry: the center locks

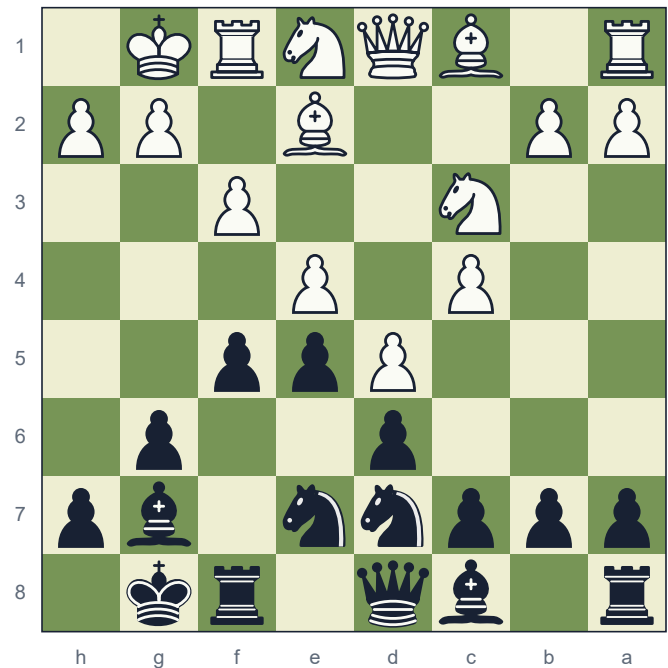
STUDY LINE 02-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. f3 f5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 10... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The c6 knight attacks d4 and is driven to e7. The f6 knight then goes to d7, vacating f6 for the f-pawn. White uses Ne1 and f3 to secure e4.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Meet White's queenside expansion with active kingside play. Decide between ...f4 and maintaining tension; first count White's captures on e5 and f5.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The two knights have different jobs. ...f5 is illegal while your own knight remains on f6.

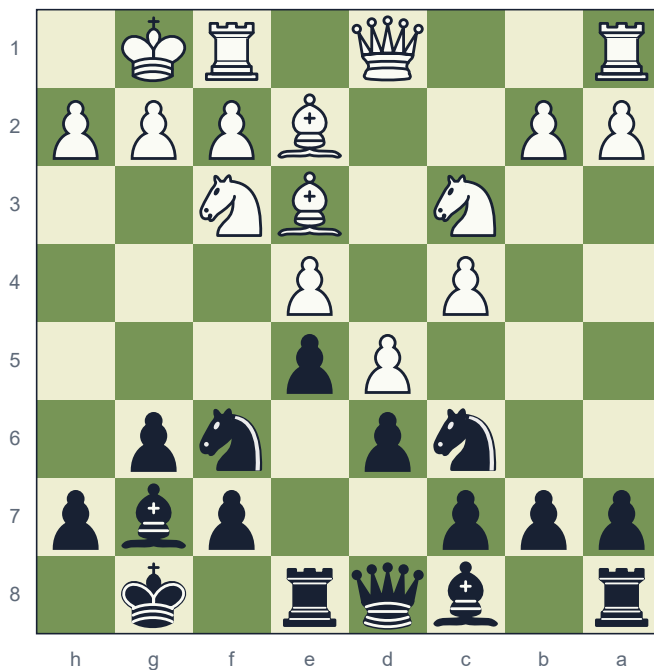
REMEMBER Close the center, reroute the knight, then choose the pawn break.

02 Be3 and the active ...Nd4 response

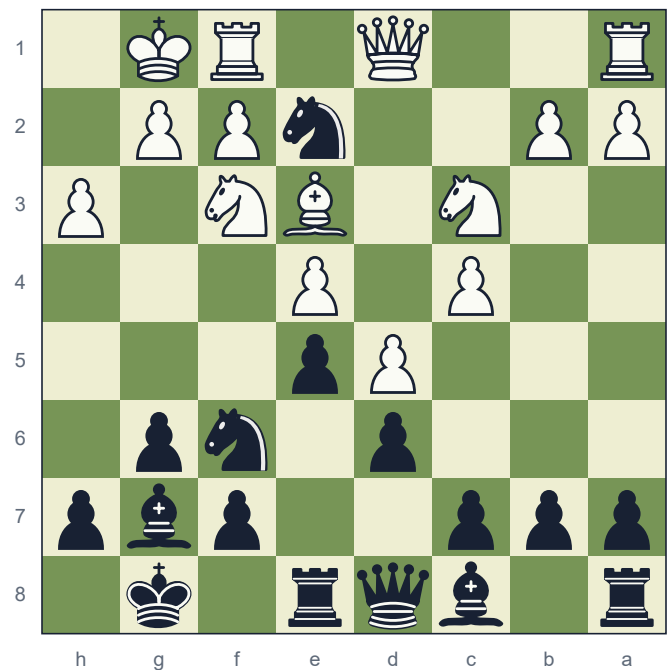
STUDY LINE 02-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Be3 Re8 9. d5 Nd4 10. h3 Nxe2+

Selected anchor ends with 9... Nd4. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move - in check

WHY THESE MOVES

Be3 supports d4 but allows a central knight contact after d5. The e5 pawn supports ...Nd4, and exchanges on d4 must account for the e-file pressure from Re8.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Calculate Bxd4 and Nxd4 before choosing a recapture. Finish development while using the active knight and the central files.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A routine retreat to e7 misses the more active resource in this exact position. Check which pawn and rook support the central knight.

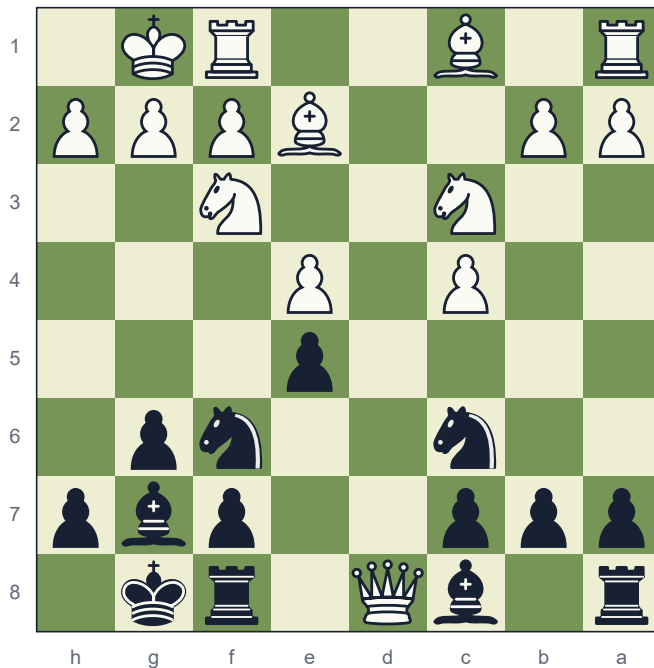
REMEMBER An attacked knight may have an active forward square.

03 White exchanges after ...Nc6

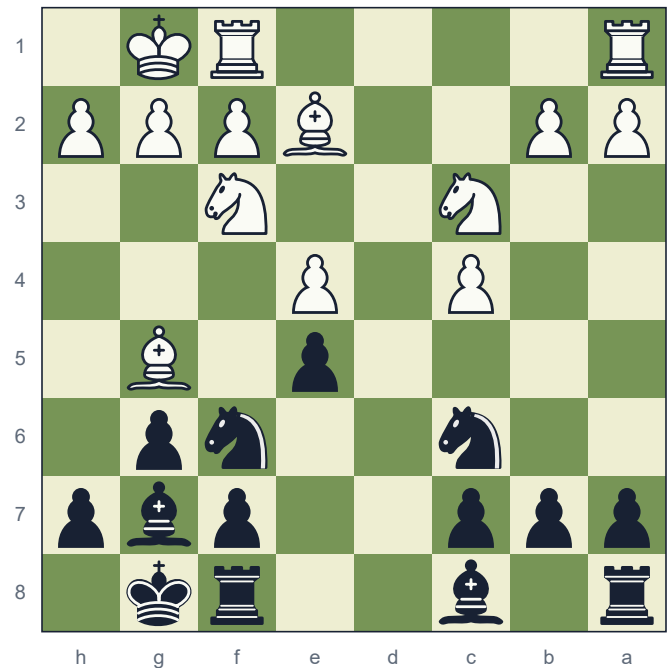
STUDY LINE 02-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. dxe5 dxe5 9. Qxd8 Rxd8 10. Bg5 Rf8

Selected anchor ends with 10. Bg5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The queen exchange removes much of the immediate mating play. The rook recaptures on d8 because Black has already castled.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the c8 bishop, contest d4, and coordinate rooks on open files. Active pieces are more valuable than an automatic pawn storm.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The d6 pawn has left d6. Reassess the center instead of continuing a closed-chain plan.

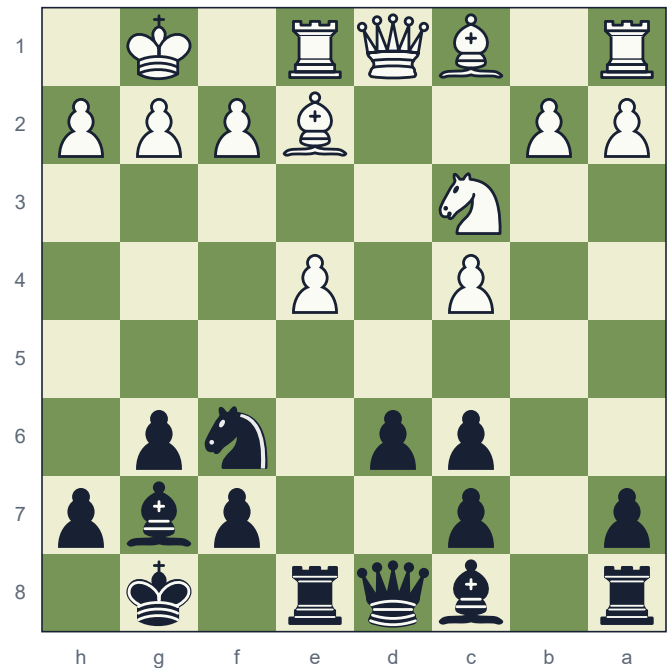
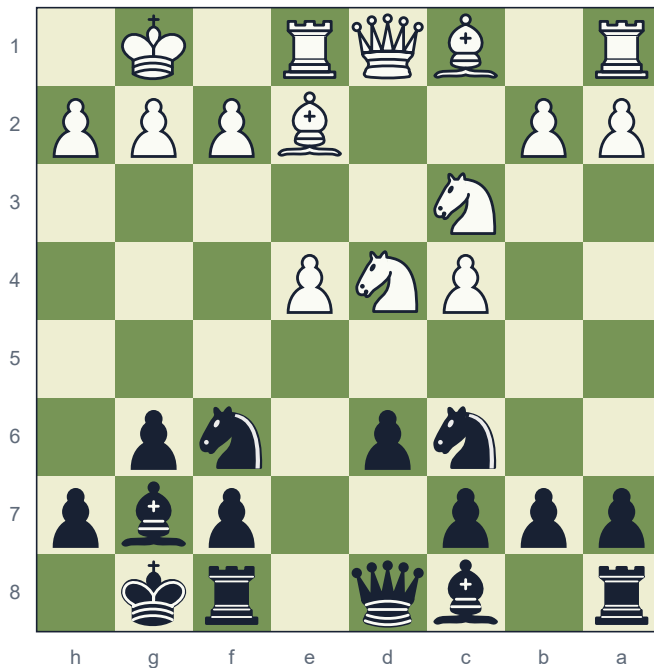
REMEMBER An open center needs active pieces.

04 Re1: release the tension with ...exd4

STUDY LINE 02-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 exd4 9. Nxd4 Re8 10. Nxc6 bxc6

Selected anchor ends with 9... Re8. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

Re1 supports e4, but the pawn exchange gives Black active pressure on the e-file and d4. ...Re8 is more purposeful after the exchange than before it here.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the c8 bishop and examine ...Nxd4 when it improves the pieces. White may reinforce e4 or bring the bishop to f1.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

There is no locked d5 chain. A kingside pawn storm would ignore the open center.

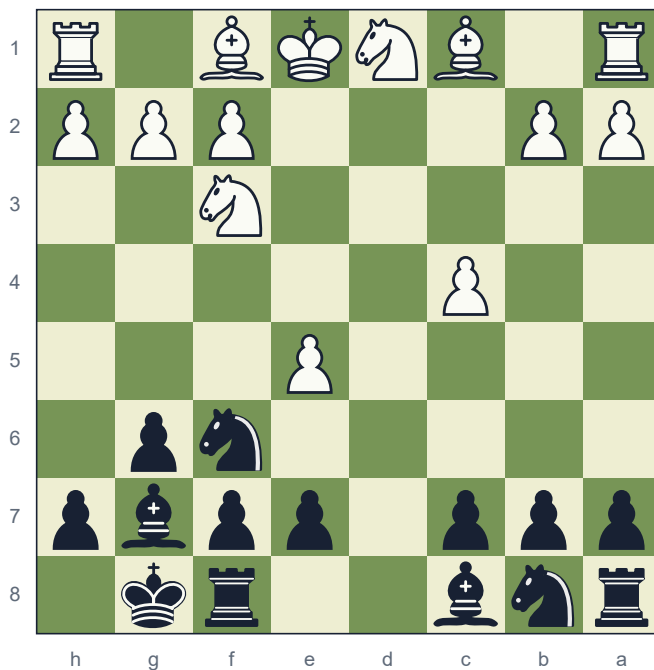
REMEMBER Exchange when it creates useful activity.

05 A premature central lunge

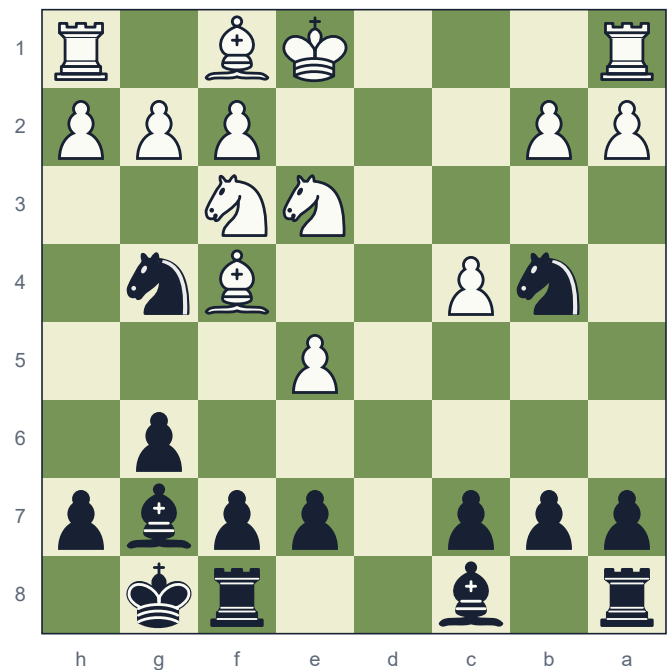
STUDY LINE 02-05

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. e5 dxe5 7. dxe5 Qxd1+ 8. Nxd1 Ng4 9. Bf4 Nc6 10. Ne3 Nb4

Selected anchor ends with 8... Ng4. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The d-pawn removes e5, and the queen exchange leaves e5 exposed. ...Ng4 develops with pressure on that pawn.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

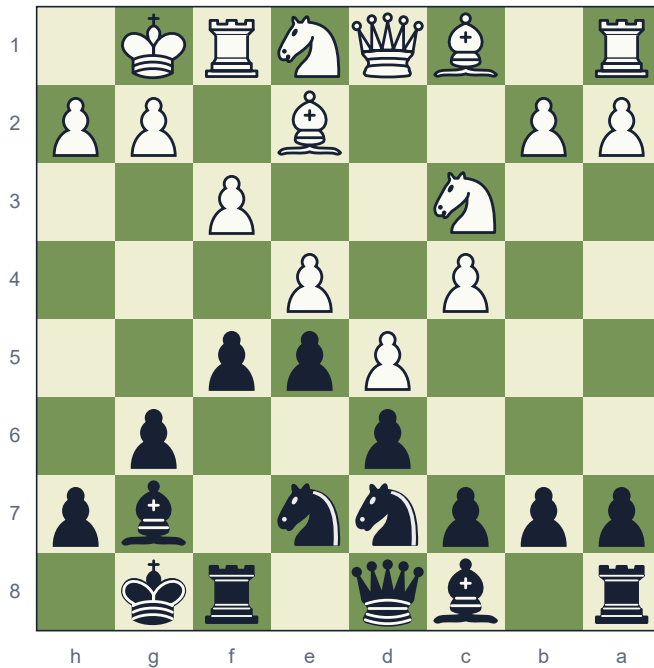
Recover or restrain e5 while completing queenside development. Keep the g7 bishop's diagonal in view.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Calculate the exchanges in their exact order. This is a concrete response to early e5, not permission to leave central threats unanswered.

REMEMBER Challenge the advanced center with captures and tempo.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

The defining choice is whether d4 meets e5 by advancing, exchanging, or remaining in contact. Only the advance creates the familiar locked chain.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White develops behind a space advantage. Re1, Be3 and exchanges on e5 can stop Black from getting a routine kingside race.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Meet White's queenside expansion with active kingside play. Decide between ...f4 and maintaining tension; first count White's captures on e5 and f5.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.